POLITY 01 — HISTORICAL BACKGROUND OF THE INDIAN CONSTITUTION

ONE CONTINUOUS AT-A-GLANCE MASTER FLOW • CORE BEFORE EXTRA • COMPANY TRADE → PARLIAMENTARY CONTROL → DUAL CONTROL → CROWN RULE → ASSOCIATION → REPRESENTATION → PROVINCIAL RESPONSIBILITY → FEDERAL ARCHITECTURE → SOVEREIGNTY

Read the thick cyan rail from top to bottom. Each numbered stage carries its own layout: causal chain, institution-versus-function split, before/after replacement, repair matrix, reserved-versus-transferred comparison, commenced-versus-not-commenced ledger, timeline bridge and synthesis matrix. The 15-stage core is complete before the lighter enrichment band begins.

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • Prior artefacts, including generation g8, unchanged

● PRIMARY CORE FLOW ● CROWN-RULE PIVOT ● SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT

AMBER headings = sourced statutory provisions • CYAN headings = mechanism and analysis • RED headings = defects, limits and traps • MAGENTA band = answer-grabbing line

0

STAGE 0 IDENTITY + SOURCE CAUTION — WHAT THIS TOPIC ACTUALLY IS

CONSTITUTIONAL EVOLUTION, NOT A MEMORISED ACT LIST · COMPANY RULE 1773–1858 · CROWN RULE 1858–1947 · RESPONSIBLE GOVERNMENT = EXECUTIVE REMOVABLE BY THE LEGISLATURE · PROVIDED ≠ OPERATED · ASSOCIATION ≠ REPRESENTATION ≠ RESPONSIBILITY

WHAT THE SYLLABUS OWNS

- **Mains GS-II:** historical underpinnings and evolution of the Constitution.
- **Prelims GS-I:** Indian Polity and Governance.
- GS-I Modern History uses are **adjacent and cross-owned**, not a separate syllabus claim.
- This is a **high-frequency static constitutional chapter**; no current-affairs insertion is evidentiary here.

THE FOUR-QUESTION READING RULE

- Read **every statute** through four questions, in this order.
- **1. Who controlled the executive?**
- **2. Who made law?**
- **3. Who paid?**
- **4. Who was represented?**
- A date without an answer to one of these four earns nothing.

THREE WORDS UPSC KEEPS APART

- **Company rule** — corporate government under progressively tighter parliamentary supervision, 1773–1858.
- **Crown rule** — Secretary of State for India plus Viceroy, from 1858; a change of sovereign, not of democracy.
- **Responsible government** — an executive politically answerable to, and removable through, the representative legislature. Never granted at the centre before 1947.

FIRST-USE TERMINOLOGY — WRITE THESE EXACT MEANINGS

TERM	EXAM-SAFE ENGLISH MEANING
Diwani	Revenue-administration and civil-justice authority granted to the Company in 1765 over Bengal, Bihar and Orissa.
Dyarchy	Dual government: subjects divided between responsible ministers and an executive authority not responsible to the legislature.
Paramountcy	The British Crown's superior authority over the princely states.
Separate electorate	A community-specific electoral roll in which community voters elect community representatives.
Reserved seat	A seat earmarked for a community, capable of operating **within a common or joint electorate**.
Responsible government	An executive politically answerable to, and removable through, the representative legislature.

SOURCE CAUTION → Two different failures lose marks here. Narrating conquest instead of constitutional design is one; listing statutes without naming the institution each created is the other. Every claim below is anchored to a named provision, and every operational limit is stated explicitly because UPSC tests the gap between what a statute **provided** and what actually **operated**.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The historical background of the Constitution is the gradual conversion of a revenue-seeking Company state into a centralised colonial administration and, finally, a sovereign democratic Constitution.

1

STAGE 1 PRE-1773 — THE CORPORATE STATE: TRADE BECOMES TERRITORIAL REVENUE POWER

1600 CHARTER = TRADE, NOT SOVEREIGNTY · QUEEN ELIZABETH I · 1765 DIWANI = REVENUE + CIVIL JUSTICE · BENGAL, BIHAR, ORISSA · BENGAL DUAL GOVERNMENT 1765–72 · CROWN RULE ONLY IN 1858

1600 — CHARTER
East India Company enters India as a trading corporation under the charter of Queen Elizabeth I.

→ **1757 — PLASSEY**
Supplies political leverage; the Company begins to intervene in government.

→ **1764 — BUXAR**
Supplies military superiority; a durable coercive base.

→ **1765 — DIWANI**
Revenue and civil-justice authority in Bengal, Bihar and Orissa. A private corporation now exercises public power.

1765–72 — BENGAL DUAL GOVERNMENT
Company holds effective revenue power; the Nawab retains nominal responsibility. Power without answerability.

→ **1772 — DUAL GOVERNMENT ENDED**
The Company assumes open responsibility for Bengal administration.

→ **1772 — LOAN APPLICATION**
Court of Directors applies to the British government for a loan; financial mismanagement is exposed to Parliament.

→ **1773 — PARLIAMENT ACTS**
A Parliamentary Secret Committee and a Select Committee of enquiry (April 1772) lead directly to the Regulating Act.

WHAT DIWANI ACTUALLY GAVE

- Revenue and civil-justice authority in **Bengal, Bihar and Orissa** — it did **not** begin Crown rule.
- Converted intermittent military success into a **durable fiscal-administrative state**.
- Made the Company a **territorial power** while its legal identity remained a chartered trading corporation.

THE ACCOUNTABILITY GAP

- Bengal's Dual Government **separated effective power from nominal responsibility**: the Company collected, the Nawab answered.
- Parliament's problem was therefore **constitutional, not moral**: a private corporation exercised sovereign functions with no public accountability chain.

WHY PARLIAMENT COULD NOT WAIT

- **Fiscal trigger:** the 1772 loan application exposed the Company's finances to parliamentary scrutiny.
- **Patronage trigger:** returning 'Nabobs' converted Indian wealth into domestic political influence, alarming Parliament.
- The documented drivers were **fiscal crisis, patronage anxiety and a demand for accountability** — not humanitarian concern.

TRAP → Diwani did **not** begin direct Crown government, and Plassey alone did not create a colonial state. Plassey created leverage; Buxar and Diwani supplied the coercive and fiscal foundations. Crown government begins only in **1858**. These events are constitutional **background**, not constitutional statutes — do not narrate eighteenth-century conquest.

2

STAGE 2 REGULATING ACT 1773 — FIRST PARLIAMENTARY CONSTITUTION FOR COMPANY GOVERNMENT

GOVERNOR-GENERAL OF BENGAL — NOT OF INDIA · NOT GOVERNOR-GENERAL OF INDIA · WARREN HASTINGS — FIRST · FOUR-MEMBER EXECUTIVE COUNCIL · BOMBAY + MADRAS SUBORDINATED · SUPREME COURT AT CALCUTTA — 1774 · 1 CHIEF JUSTICE + 3 JUDGES · COURT OF DIRECTORS MUST REPORT

WHAT THE ACT BUILT

Parliament's first major statutory intervention in Company government.

- **Governor-General of Bengal** with a four-member Executive Council; first holder **Warren Hastings**.
- Governors of **Bombay and Madras made subordinate** to the Governor-General of Bengal in specified matters — notably war and peace.
- **Supreme Court at Calcutta**, one Chief Justice and three judges, functioning from **1774**.
- Company servants **barred from private trade and from accepting presents or bribes**.
- **Court of Directors** required to report **revenue, civil and military** affairs to the British government.

CENTRALISATION WITHOUT RESPONSIBILITY
Institutions were created; a chain of political answerability was not.

DEFECTS THE ACT LEFT BEHIND

Each defect names the later statute that repaired it.

- **No responsible government:** no Indian representation and no executive answerable to any legislature.
- **Council arithmetic:** the four-member Council gave the Governor-General no tie-breaking advantage beyond a casting vote usable only on an even split. Hastings was regularly outvoted three-to-one on Bengal policy in 1774–76; the deadlock ended only when Monson died in 1776 — chance, not a statutory fix. Repaired by **1784's smaller council and the 1786 override**.
- **Undefined jurisdiction:** the Supreme Court's authority over Company servants' official acts and the Diwani-derived Adalats was left dangerously vague, producing the **Nand Kumar (1775)**, **Patna (1777–79)** and **Cossijurah (1779–80)** collisions. Repaired by **1781**.
- **Weak supervision:** a mere reporting duty owed by the Court of Directors gave Parliament **disclosure, not control**. Repaired by **1784**.
- **Partial subordination:** Bombay and Madras were subordinate only in specified matters, so central control remained incomplete.

MECHANISM → The statute began **centralisation and judicialisation** simultaneously — one central executive office and one royal court — but it supplied no rule for resolving conflict either **inside** the executive or **between** executive and court. Every subsequent Company-era statute until 1858 is a repair of one of those two unresolved relationships.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The Regulating Act 1773 was Parliament's first constitutional response to the mismatch between the Company's territorial power and its public accountability.

3

STAGE 3 AMENDING (SETTLEMENT) ACT 1781 — A NARROW, EXACT JURISDICTIONAL REPAIR

OFFICIAL ACTS EXEMPTED · REVENUE MATTERS EXCLUDED · HINDU LAW TO HINDUS, MUSLIM LAW TO MUSLIMS · APPEALS → GOVERNOR-GENERAL-IN-COUNCIL · JURISDICTION REPAIR ≠ EXECUTIVE REPAIR

POINT OF COLLISION	POSITION LEFT BY 1773	EXACT 1781 REPAIR
Executive vs court	Governor-General-in-Council and Company servants exposed to Supreme Court process for acts done in office.	**Exempted** the Governor-General-in-Council's own official acts, and Company servants' acts done in an official or public capacity, from Supreme Court jurisdiction.
Revenue	Revenue administration open to Supreme Court interference — the Cossijurah flashpoint.	**Excluded revenue-collection matters entirely**, routing them to the Company's own revenue courts with appeal before the Governor-General-in-Council.
Which law for whom	Uncertain application of personal law to Calcutta's inhabitants.	Directed the Supreme Court to apply **Hindu law to Hindus and Muslim law to Muslims** in personal-law matters — marriage, inheritance, caste usage and religious practice.
Appeals	No settled route from provincial Company courts — the Patna Case flashpoint.	Appeals from **provincial courts routed to the Governor-General-in-Council** (and the Sadar Diwani Adalat), not to the Supreme Court.

WHAT IT REPAIRED

- Removed the **disputed zone** between the royal court and the Company's Diwani-derived judicial system.
- Protected the **capacity to administer revenue** free from ordinary civil-court interference.
- Gave the executive a defensible legal shield for official action.

WHAT IT DID NOT REPAIR

- It corrected **Supreme Court jurisdiction only**.
- It did **not** resolve the Council's three-to-one deadlock — that needed **1784's smaller council and 1786's override power**.
- It did **not** transfer general appellate authority in provincial matters to the Supreme Court, and it did **not** establish modern judicial review.
- It gave Indians no share in legislation or executive power.

HOW TO USE IT IN AN ANSWER

- Treat 1781 as evidence of **institutional improvisation**, not of a settled separation of powers.
- Keep **jurisdiction correction** and **executive deadlock correction** as two entirely separate statutory fixes arriving in different Acts and different years.

BRIDGE → 1781 repaired the courts. It left untouched the deeper question of **who in London actually controlled Indian government**. The next statute answers that question by splitting the control chain itself.

4

STAGE 4 PITT'S INDIA ACT 1784 (+ THE ACT OF 1786) — DOUBLE GOVERNMENT: THE INSTITUTIONAL SPLIT

COMMERCIAL vs POLITICAL FUNCTIONS DISTINGUISHED · BOARD OF CONTROL · COURT OF DIRECTORS RETAINED · DOUBLE GOVERNMENT / DUAL CONTROL · “SUPERINTEND, DIRECT AND CONTROL” · “BRITISH POSSESSIONS IN INDIA” — FIRST TIME · SECRET COMMITTEE TRANSMISSION · 1786 — OVERRIDE + COMMANDER-IN-CHIEF

BOARD OF CONTROL — POLITICAL SIDE

The British Government's own instrument, created in 1784.

- Empowered in the Act's own phrasing to **"superintend, direct and control"** the government of the Company's possessions.
- Covered the **political, civil, military and revenue** government of the territories — the whole of public administration.
- Constituted as a board of **six commissioners**, including a **Secretary of State** and the **Chancellor of the Exchequer**.
- Board orders binding on Indian administration were **transmitted to the Court of Directors through a Secret Committee of Directors**, providing a channel for urgent or confidential orders without full deliberation by the whole Court.
- Result: the **British Government acquired supreme control** over Indian administration.

DOUBLE GOVERNMENT 1784–1858
Two bodies in London, one administration in India. Policy control moved to the British state while operational machinery stayed corporate.

COURT OF DIRECTORS — COMMERCIAL SIDE

The Company's own body — retained, not abolished, in 1784.

- Retained **commercial administration** of the Company and its **patronage**.
- The Company's **trade monopoly remained fully intact** under this Act, in exchange for accepting the new political superintendence.
- The Company's governing council in India was **reduced in size**, curing part of the 1773 deadlock defect.
- The Court of Directors **continued until 1858** — Pitt's Act did not abolish Company rule.
- Consequence: the Crown could direct policy **without nationalising Company assets or assuming its fiscal liabilities**.

ACT OF 1786
Lord Cornwallis appointed Governor-General with power to OVERRIDE his own council, and additionally made Commander-in-Chief.

→ **CHARTER ACT 1793**
The override power is extended to all future Governors-General and Governors; Board of Control staff paid from Indian revenues.

EXACT CONSEQUENCE

- The Act **first described the Company's territories as "British possessions in India"**.
- Executive command was strengthened **faster than legislative accountability** — the 1786 override precedes any Indian legislative voice by three-quarters of a century.
- Dual control was a genuine **accountability ambiguity**, not merely an administrative arrangement.

WHAT PITT'S ACT DID NOT DO

- It did **not** transfer India to the Crown — that is **1858**.
- It did **not** create cabinet responsibility in India.
- It did **not** abolish the Company or its monopoly.

CLOSE-OPTION CONTROL

- Wrong: the Board of Control managed only Company trade. **Correct:** it supervised political, civil, military and revenue affairs; **trade stayed with the Court of Directors**.
- **Dual control (1784–1858)** in London is not **Bengal's Dual Government (1765–72)**. Different bodies, different countries, different century-problems.

WHY THIS STAGE DECIDES MARKS

- 1784 is the only statute where the examiner can test a **clean two-column institutional split**: name the body, name its function, name what it did not touch.
- It is also the design that **1858 abolishes wholesale** — so this split is the 'before' picture of the Crown-rule diagram.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Pitt's India Act 1784 created dual control: Company directors retained commercial administration while the British government, through the Board of Control, acquired supreme political supervision.

5

STAGE 5 CHARTER ACTS 1793 AND 1813 — MONOPOLY RENEWED, THEN LOST EXCEPT TEA AND CHINA

1793 — MONOPOLY EXTENDED 20 YEARS · BOARD OF CONTROL STAFF PAID FROM INDIAN REVENUES · 1813 — MONOPOLY ENDS · EXCEPT TEA AND TRADE WITH CHINA · CROWN SOVEREIGNTY ASSERTED · MISSIONARIES PERMITTED · ONE LAKH RUPEES ANNUALLY FOR EDUCATION · LOCAL GOVERNMENTS MAY IMPOSE TAXES

DIMENSION	CHARTER ACT 1793	CHARTER ACT 1813
Trade	Company's commercial **monopoly extended for a further twenty years**.	**Ended the Company's monopoly over Indian trade, opening it to all British merchants — except trade in tea and trade with China.**
Constitutional claim	Existing control consolidated; the 1786 override extended to all future Governors-General and Governors.	**Expressly asserted the sovereignty of the British Crown** over the Indian territories held by the Company.
Money	**Board of Control staff paid from Indian revenues** — British supervision financed by Indian taxpayers.	Local governments in India empowered to **impose taxes**.
Education and mission	No comparable opening.	Sanctioned **one lakh rupees annually** for education and the encouragement of learning; **permitted Christian missionaries**.

1793 — MONOPOLY RENEWED
Company's commercial monopoly extended twenty years; the dual-control machinery of 1784 consolidated.

→ **BRITISH FREE-TRADE PRESSURE**
Industrial and mercantile interests in Britain demand entry to the Indian market.

→ **1813 — MONOPOLY BROKEN**
Indian trade thrown open to all British merchants; tea and the China trade kept back.

→ **SOVEREIGNTY ASSERTED**
The same statute expressly declares the sovereignty of the British Crown over the Company's Indian territories.

→ **STATE ENTERS SOCIETY**
Missionaries permitted; one lakh rupees annually for education — the state begins acting on Indian society.

WHY BOTH STATUTES MATTER

- **Three pressures converged in one statute:** British free-trade interests wanted the Indian market, missionary lobbies wanted entry, and the imperial state wanted an unambiguous claim of sovereignty.
- The direction of travel is therefore **economic opening plus constitutional tightening at the same moment** — commerce liberalised while sovereignty was asserted.
- Crown **sovereignty** is asserted in 1813; Crown **rule** begins only in 1858. Hold the two apart.

LIMITS — STATE THEM EXPLICITLY

- The education grant **did not settle the Orientalist–Anglicist controversy** and did not itself create mass education.
- Parliament did **not** thereby take direct control of Indian revenues.
- Wrong: 1813 ended every Company monopoly. **Correct:** tea and China trade remained exceptions.

PYQ CONTROL — 2019 PRELIMS GS-I Q4

- Statement 1 (monopoly ended except tea and China) — **correct**.
- Statement 2 (Crown sovereignty asserted) — **correct**.
- Statement 3 (revenues of India now controlled by the British Parliament) — **overstated, therefore false**.
- **Answer: (a) 1 and 2 only.** Official key unavailable locally; inferred, high confidence. True routing owner: Modern Indian History Topic 06.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The Charter Acts 1793 and 1813 show that monopoly could be renewed even as Crown sovereignty and regulated commercial opening advanced.

6

STAGE 6 CHARTER ACT 1833 — THE ALL-INDIA STATE: FINAL STEP OF CENTRALISATION

GOVERNOR-GENERAL OF BENGAL → OF INDIA · WILLIAM BENTINCK — FIRST · GOVERNMENT OF INDIA CREATED · BOMBAY + MADRAS LOSE LEGISLATIVE POWER · “REGULATIONS” → “ACTS” · COMPANY BECOMES PURELY ADMINISTRATIVE · TERRITORIES HELD “IN TRUST FOR HIS MAJESTY” · LAW MEMBER — MACAULAY · FIRST LAW COMMISSION 1834

BEFORE 1833

- **Governor-General of Bengal** — a presidency office with partial supervisory reach.
- Three presidencies **legislating separately**; presidency law-making called **Regulations**.
- Company still a **trading corporation** that also governed territory.
- Civil-service entry effectively by **patronage** of the Court of Directors.

ONE GOVERNMENT FOR ALL BRITISH INDIA →

AFTER 1833

- **Governor-General of India** with all civil and military powers; first holder **Lord William Bentinck**.
- A single **Government of India** over all British India; **Bombay and Madras lose legislative powers**; central law is now called **Acts**.
- Company becomes a **purely administrative body**, holding territories **"in trust for His Majesty"** — its commercial character ends.
- A fourth, **Law Member** added to the Council — **Macaulay** the first — and the **first Law Commission (1834)** follows.

CONTINUITY CAUTION The 1833 Act attempted **open competition** for the civil services, but the attempt was **negated by the Court of Directors' opposition**; and its **equality clause did not produce equal recruitment in practice**. Centralisation was real; merit and equality remained rhetoric until later statutes and, in substance, long after.

LAW AND CODIFICATION

- The Law Member plus the Law Commission converted colonial rule into a **codifying, legislating state**.
- Renaming presidency **Regulations** as central **Acts** is not cosmetic: it marks the **legislative monopoly of one all-India authority**.

WHY THIS IS THE 'ALL-INDIA STATE' SHIFT

- Before 1833 the Company governed **territories**; after 1833 it administers a **single state** with one legislature and one executive head.
- Centralisation, codification and merit rhetoric together built a **professional state**, while racial and imperial constraints limited equality.

WHAT DID NOT CHANGE

- **No Indian representation** and no responsible government.
- **Company government continued** — abolition belongs to **1858**, not 1833 and not 1853.
- Wrong: open competition was fully realised in 1833. **Correct:** the 1833 opening was frustrated; 1853 established open competition in principle.

PYQ CONTROL → **2023 Prelims GS-I Q50** — by which Act was the Governor-General of Bengal designated Governor-General of India? **Answer: (d) The Charter Act of 1833.** William Bentinck was the first. Official key unavailable locally; inferred, very high confidence. True routing owner: Modern Indian History Topic 06.

7

STAGE 7 CHARTER ACT 1853 — LAST CHARTER ACT: FUNCTION SPLIT, COMPETITION, NO FIXED TERM

LEGISLATIVE AND EXECUTIVE FUNCTIONS SEPARATED · SIX NEW LEGISLATIVE COUNCILLORS · INDIAN (CENTRAL) LEGISLATIVE COUNCIL · “MINI-PARLIAMENT” · OPEN COMPETITION FOR CIVIL SERVICE · OPEN TO INDIANS · MACAULAY COMMITTEE 1854 · 4 OF 6 FROM MADRAS, BOMBAY, BENGAL, AGRA · NO FIXED RENEWAL TERM

GOVERNOR-GENERAL'S COUNCIL BEFORE 1853
One body performing executive administration and law-making together — legislation was an incident of executive business.

- **1853 SPLITS THE FUNCTIONS**
  The legislative and executive work of the Governor-General's Council is separated for the first time.
  - **SIX NEW LEGISLATIVE COUNCILLORS ADDED**
    A differentiated central legislative council — the Indian (Central) Legislative Council — begins to behave like a deliberative chamber and is sometimes described as a 'mini-Parliament'.
    - **FOUR OF THE SIX REPRESENT MADRAS, BOMBAY, BENGAL AND AGRA**
      The first appearance of local representation inside central law-making — territorial, not popular, and by nomination.
      - **LEGISLATION BECOMES A DISTINCT STATE FUNCTION**
        Law-making is now differentiated from executive administration and from patronage. This is the institutional ancestor of every later legislative-council reform.

OPEN COMPETITION — THE SERVICE STATE

- Introduced **open competition** for the civil service, **open to Indians**, ending recruitment purely by directors' patronage in principle.
- The **Macaulay Committee of 1854** on the civil service followed directly.
- 1833 attempted competition and was frustrated; **1853 establishes the principle**. Keep the two Acts distinct.

TENURE — THE POLITICAL TIME-BOMB

- Company rule was extended **without a fixed renewal term**, so **Parliament could end it at any time**.
- This is the last Charter Act; there is no 1873 renewal to look for.
- Wrong: 1853 ended Company government. **Correct:** it made Company tenure provisional; government ended in **1858**.

BRIDGE TO CROWN TAKEOVER

- The Revolt of 1857 supplied the **occasion** for transfer; the 1853 tenure clause supplied the **legal ease**.
- By 1853 the Company had already lost its **commerce (1833)** and its **security of tenure (1853)**. Only the shell of corporate government remained for 1858 to remove.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The Charter Acts 1833 and 1853 completed legislative centralisation, ended the Company's commercial character and differentiated law-making from executive administration and patronage.

8

STAGE 8 GOVERNMENT OF INDIA ACT 1858 — CROWN RULE BEGINS

“ACT FOR THE GOOD GOVERNMENT OF INDIA” · EAST INDIA COMPANY ABOLISHED · DOUBLE GOVERNMENT ENDED · SECRETARY OF STATE FOR INDIA · MEMBER OF THE BRITISH CABINET · COUNCIL OF INDIA — 15 MEMBERS, ADVISORY · GOVERNOR-GENERAL ALSO STYLED VICEROY · LORD CANNING — FIRST VICEROY · AFTER THE REVOLT OF 1857

ABOLISHED IN 1858

- The **East India Company** as a governing body — power transferred to the British Crown.
- The **Court of Directors**.
- The **Board of Control**.
- The whole **double government / dual control** design created around 1784 and operating since.

TRANSFER OF GOVERNMENT TO THE BRITISH CROWN, 1858 →

CREATED IN 1858

- **Secretary of State for India** — a member of the British Cabinet, holding direct responsibility for Indian government.
- **Council of India** — fifteen members in the original arrangement, assisting the Secretary of State.
- **Viceroy** — the Governor-General of India additionally becomes the direct representative of the Crown; **Lord Canning** the first.
- A single, undivided **imperial line of command** replacing two competing London bodies.

CONTINUITY CAUTION Administrative personnel, machinery and habits **substantially continued** across 1858. The Act changed the **sovereign and the supervision architecture**; it was not a total institutional rupture, and it created **no Indian popular responsibility whatever**.

BRITISH ELECTORATE
Votes in Britain.

→ **BRITISH PARLIAMENT**
Holds the Cabinet to account.

→ **BRITISH CABINET**
Contains the Secretary of State for India.

→ **SECRETARY OF STATE FOR INDIA**
Assisted by the Council of India (advisory).

→ **VICEROY / GOVERNOR-GENERAL**
Executive head in India, Crown's representative.

→ **INDIAN ADMINISTRATION**
Provinces, services, revenue and army.

READ THE CHAIN ABOVE → There is **no Indian link anywhere in it**. The transfer clarified the imperial **principal–agent chain** but did not democratise it: the Secretary of State was responsible to **British**, not Indian, politics. This single observation converts 1858 from a date into an argument.

WHAT INDIANS DID NOT GET

- No responsible government; the executive remained answerable only through London.
- No legislature with control over supply, and no electorate.
- Crown proclamations of non-interference and equal treatment must be **distinguished from implementation**.

CLOSE-OPTION CONTROL

- Wrong: Viceroy was a wholly separate office from Governor-General. **Correct:** the Governor-General **also acted as** Viceroy, the Crown's representative.
- Wrong: 1858 introduced responsible government. **Correct:** it centralised imperial accountability without making the executive responsible to Indians.

THE ONE-LINE PERIODISATION MARKER

- Everything **above** this stage is **Company rule under parliamentary supervision**.
- Everything **below** it is **Crown rule** — and from here the constitutional question changes from "who supervises the Company" to "who, if anyone, represents Indians".

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The Government of India Act 1858 replaced dual control with direct Crown responsibility, but centralised imperial accountability without Indian popular responsibility.

9

STAGE 9 INDIAN COUNCILS ACTS 1861 AND 1892 — ASSOCIATION AND SCRUTINY, NOT RESPONSIBILITY

PORTFOLIO SYSTEM RECOGNISED — CANNING 1859 · NON-OFFICIAL INDIANS NOMINATED — 1862 · DECENTRALISATION: BOMBAY + MADRAS RESTORED · VICEROY'S ORDINANCE — SIX-MONTH LIFE · 1892 — BUDGET DISCUSSION + QUESTIONS · THE WORD “ELECTION” AVOIDED · “NOMINATION ON RECOMMENDATION” · OFFICIAL MAJORITY RETAINED

TEST	INDIAN COUNCILS ACT 1861	INDIAN COUNCILS ACT 1892
Entry of Indians	**Nomination** of non-official Indians to legislative work — the beginning of representative institutions in form.	**Indirect election in substance** through bodies recommending nominees; the word 'election' was deliberately avoided.
Legislative geography	**Decentralisation** — legislative powers restored to **Bombay and Madras**; new councils for Bengal, the North-Western Provinces and Punjab.	Councils **enlarged** with more non-official members, but the balance of control was untouched.
Executive control	Viceroy retained legislative control and could issue **ordinances with a six-month life**; the **portfolio system** was recognised.	**Official majority retained** at the centre; the executive remained irremovable.
Financial power	No financial control conceded.	Power to **discuss the budget** and to **question the executive** — discussion, not the vote of supply.
Constitutional name for it	**Association** — Indians present in law-making, chosen by government.	**Scrutiny** — Indians questioning government, still unable to remove it.

NAMED EVIDENCE — 1862 NOMINEES

- Canning's first non-official Indian nominees were the **Raja of Benaras**, the **Maharaja of Patiala** and **Sir Dinkar Rao**.
- New legislative councils followed for **Bengal (1862), the North-Western Provinces (1886) and Punjab (1897)**.
- The **portfolio system**, used by Canning from **1859**, was given statutory recognition in 1861.

THE MECHANISM: SCRUTINY BEFORE RESPONSIBILITY

- Legislative **scrutiny developed decades before executive responsibility** — that ordering is the whole argument of this stage.
- Association was designed to **strengthen colonial legitimacy**, not to surrender executive control: loyal notables were brought inside the machinery rather than left outside it.
- 1861 is also a **decentralising** statute, reversing part of the 1833 legislative monopoly — centralisation and decentralisation alternate across this topic.

TRAPS

- Wrong: 1861 introduced elected Indian representatives. **Correct:** it associated **nominated** non-official Indians.
- Wrong: budget discussion in 1892 made the executive removable. **Correct:** discussion and questions created **no confidence responsibility**.
- **Indirect election is not direct popular election**, and neither Act created a democratic franchise.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The Councils Acts 1861 and 1892 moved from nominated association to limited scrutiny, not to responsible government.

10

STAGE 10 INDIAN COUNCILS ACT 1909 (MORLEY–MINTO) — REPRESENTATION PLUS COMMUNAL SEPARATION

CENTRAL LEGISLATIVE COUNCIL 16 → 60 · OFFICIAL MAJORITY RETAINED AT THE CENTRE · NON-OFFICIAL MAJORITY IN PROVINCES · SEPARATE ELECTORATE FOR MUSLIMS · S. P. SINHA — FIRST INDIAN IN VICEROY'S EXECUTIVE COUNCIL · LAW MEMBER · MINTO — “FATHER OF COMMUNAL ELECTORATE” · “LEGALISED COMMUNALISM”

SEPARATE ELECTORATE — 1909

What the Act actually introduced.

- A **community-specific electoral roll**: Muslim voters elect Muslim representatives in designated seats.
- It **separates the electorate itself**, not merely the seat.
- Communal political identity thereby received **statutory form** — the reason it is called 'legalised communalism'.
- Extended in **1919** to Sikhs, Indian Christians, Anglo-Indians and Europeans; in **1932** by the Communal Award to the depressed classes.

NOT THE SAME DEVICE
UPSC repeatedly tests this exact distinction. Learn it as two separate electoral architectures, not two words for one idea.

RESERVED SEAT IN A JOINT ELECTORATE

The contrasting device — the one adopted later at Poona and retained in 1950.

- A seat **earmarked for a community** but filled by a **common or joint electorate** in which all voters participate.
- The roll stays **single**; only the candidate's eligibility is restricted.
- This is the **Poona Pact (1932)** settlement for the depressed classes, replacing the Communal Award's separate electorates.
- The Constitution of 1950 **rejected separate electorates** and retained reservation inside a **joint electorate with universal adult franchise**.

WHAT WAS ENLARGED

- Central legislative council membership raised from **sixteen to sixty**.
- **Non-official majorities** appeared in some provincial councils.
- **Satyendra Prasad Sinha** became the **first Indian on the Viceroy's Executive Council**, as **Law Member**.
- More discussion, more non-official presence, wider representative procedure.

WHAT WAS NOT GIVEN

- **Official control at the centre survived** — the central council kept an official majority.
- The executive **remained irresponsible**: no removal, no confidence, no ministry.
- The Act did **not** introduce dyarchy, provincial autonomy or responsible government.

CAUSATION — DO NOT WRITE A MONO-CAUSAL LINE

- **Both** British divide-and-rule incentives and organised Muslim elite demands formed the electoral context; single-cause answers are weak.
- The paradox to state: **representation widened at the very moment the electorate was segmented by community** — a concession and a constitutional warning in one statute.

TRAP → 1909 is **not** dyarchy — dyarchy is **1919**. S. P. Sinha is a **1909** fact, not a 1919 appointee. And a separate electorate is **not merely a reserved seat**: it also separates the electoral roll and the electorate by community.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (CRITICISM): The 1909 reforms widened representation by institutionalising religious separation, making separate electorates both a concession and a constitutional warning.

11

STAGE 11 GOVERNMENT OF INDIA ACT 1919 (MONTAGU–CHELMSFORD) — DYARCHY: RESPONSIBILITY WITHOUT CONTROL

MONTAGU DECLARATION 1917 · MAIN REFORMS IN FORCE 1921 · CENTRAL AND PROVINCIAL SUBJECTS SEPARATED · DYARCHY = DI-ARCHE = DOUBLE RULE · RESERVED vs TRANSFERRED · FIRST BICAMERALISM AT THE CENTRE · FIRST DIRECT ELECTIONS · 3 OF 6 IN VICEROY'S COUNCIL TO BE INDIAN · CENTRAL PUBLIC SERVICE COMMISSION 1926 · STATUTORY COMMISSION AFTER TEN YEARS

RESERVED SUBJECTS

Administered by the Governor and his Executive Council.

- **Not responsible** to the provincial legislature in any way.
- Retained the **core fields of finance and police** — money and coercion.
- The Governor kept **override authority** over the whole provincial government.
- Ministers had **no control** over these subjects, yet shared the blame for the government's record.

DYARCHY IN THE PROVINCES
One province, one Governor, two halves of government answerable to two different masters.

TRANSFERRED SUBJECTS

Administered by the Governor acting with ministers responsible to the provincial legislature.

- The **first real responsibility** conceded anywhere in British India — and only at provincial level.
- **Local self-government** was a transferred field under dyarchy.
- Ministers were answerable to an electorate defined by **property, tax and education qualifications**.
- Their departments depended on funds they did **not** control.

THE CENTRE — WHAT CHANGED

- Central and provincial subjects **separated for the first time**, though the structure remained **unitary**.
- **Bicameralism** at the centre: **Council of State** (upper) and **Legislative Assembly** (lower).
- **Direct elections** appeared at the central level.
- **Three of six** members of the Viceroy's Executive Council, excluding the Commander-in-Chief, were to be **Indian**.
- The central executive remained **not responsible** to the legislature.

FRANCHISE AND ELECTORATES

- Franchise limited by **property, tax and education** qualifications — a small and unequal electorate.
- **Separate electorates extended beyond Muslims** to **Sikhs, Indian Christians, Anglo-Indians and Europeans**.
- Communal representation therefore **widened** in the same statute that promised responsible government.

MONEY, SERVICES AND REVIEW

- **Provincial budgets separated** from the central budget.
- **High Commissioner for India** provided in London.
- **Central Public Service Commission** established in **1926** — the institutional ancestor of the UPSC.
- A **statutory commission after ten years** was promised — the clause that produces the Simon Commission.

MECHANISM — WHY DYARCHY FAILED → Apply the governance test of **functions, finances and functionaries**. Ministers received **functions** but neither **finances** (finance was reserved) nor **functionaries** (the services and the police answered elsewhere), and the Governor retained **override**. Political responsibility was therefore never matched by fiscal, coercive or overriding authority — responsibility without control is the exact formulation to write.

1927 Simon Commission appointed — seven members, all British
1928 Commission reaches India; nationwide boycott over Indian exclusion
1930 Report: abolish provincial dyarchy, responsible government in provinces, federation including princely states + First Round Table Conference
1931 Second Round Table Conference
1932 Communal Award extends separate electorates to depressed classes; Poona Pact substitutes reserved seats in a joint electorate; Third Round Table Conference
1933–34 White Paper and Joint Select Committee
1935 Government of India Act enacted

BRIDGE — WHAT THE ROAD TO 1935 PROVES

- Indian political pressure **altered the reform agenda**; British safeguards **bounded the concession**. Constitutional reform here is **bargaining under unequal sovereignty**.
- Gandhi's fast and the negotiations with **B. R. Ambedkar** produced the **Poona Pact**: reservation **inside** joint electorates, in place of Ramsay MacDonald's Communal Award.
- These are **bridges**, not substitutes for the enacted 1935 text.

TRAPS ACROSS 1919 AND THE BRIDGE

- Wrong: transferred ministers controlled finance and police. **Correct:** core reserved fields stayed with the Governor and Executive Council.
- Wrong: 1919 created provincial autonomy. **Correct:** provincial autonomy belongs to **1935**; 1919 is **dyarchy**.
- Wrong: the Poona Pact retained separate electorates for depressed classes. **Correct:** it substituted **reserved seats within joint electorates**.
- Wrong: Simon alone wrote the 1935 Act. **Correct:** report → conferences → White Paper → Joint Select Committee → Act.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (CRITICISM): The 1919 Act introduced provincial dyarchy — responsibility without control over finance and coercion — and thereby exposed the limits of divided executive authority.

12

STAGE 12 GOVERNMENT OF INDIA ACT 1935 — INSTITUTIONAL TEMPLATE WITHOUT SOVEREIGNTY

321 SECTIONS · 10 SCHEDULES · FEDERAL 59 / PROVINCIAL 54 / CONCURRENT 36 · RESIDUARY → GOVERNOR-GENERAL · PROVINCIAL DYARCHY ABOLISHED · PROVINCIAL AUTONOMY FROM 1937 · DYARCHY AT THE CENTRE — NEVER OPERATED · FEDERATION — NEVER COMMENCED · FEDERAL COURT 1937 · COUNCIL OF INDIA ABOLISHED · BICAMERALISM IN 6 OF 11 PROVINCES

COMMENCED versus NOT COMMENCED — BUILD EVERY 1935 ANSWER IN THESE TWO COLUMNS

PROVISION	LEGAL DESIGN IN THE ACT	OPERATIONAL STATUS
All-India Federation	A federation of the British Indian **provinces plus acceding princely states**.	**NEVER COMMENCED** — the accession condition failed; the princely states stayed out.
Provincial autonomy	Provincial dyarchy **abolished**; ministers responsible to provincial legislatures.	**OPERATED from 1937**, subject to gubernatorial safeguards; Congress ministries resigned in **1939**.
Dyarchy at the Centre	Reserved and transferred **federal** subjects at the proposed centre.	**NEVER OPERATED.**
Three lists + residuary	**Federal 59, Provincial 54, Concurrent 36** entries; residuary authority vested in the **Governor-General**, who could allocate a matter.	Distribution **influenced 1950 but is not identical** to the Union/State/Concurrent scheme.
Federal Court	Federal adjudication provided for.	**OPENED IN 1937** — the predecessor environment of the Supreme Court.
Franchise	Expanded but **qualification-based**, roughly one-tenth of the population.	Operated, and remained **restricted** — rejected in 1950 by universal adult franchise.

SAFEGUARDS AND DISCRETION — THE CEILING

- Governors retained extensive **discretionary powers and special responsibilities**; provincial ministers held no unrestricted power.
- **Defence, external affairs, ecclesiastical affairs and tribal areas** were reserved under the Governor-General at the proposed centre.
- Autonomy was therefore **conditional, not sovereign** — the safeguards define the ceiling of the concession.

INSTITUTIONS ADDED OR ALTERED

- **Federal, Provincial and Joint Public Service Commissions** — the UPSC/SPSC lineage.
- **Bicameralism in six provinces**: Bengal, Bombay, Madras, Bihar, Assam and the United Provinces.
- **Council of India abolished.**
- Separate representation **extended to the depressed classes, women and labour**.
- **Burma separated** under the statutory arrangement (1937).

SOURCE CAUTION — RBI → The Reserve Bank of India appears in the Advanced owner's 1935 feature list, but the Basic owner records the precise position: **the RBI was constituted under the Reserve Bank of India Act 1934 and began in 1935**. Describe the 1935 constitutional framework as **providing for or recognising** the central-banking arrangement — never as the sole creating statute. Likewise, do not convert the approximate one-tenth franchise share into a precise electorate count.

PYQ CONTROL → **2024 Prelims GS-I Q62 (direct Polity 01 owner, official Set-A paper and key verified locally): Answer (a) 1 only.** Statement 1 is correct **as a provision** even though the federation never commenced; statement 2 is false because **defence and foreign affairs were reserved under the Governor-General**, not controlled by the federal legislature. **2018 Prelims GS-I Q38: Answer (b) Governor-General** held the residuary allocation — official key unavailable locally, inferred, very high confidence.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The 1935 Act designed a federation and operative provincial autonomy, but the All-India Federation and central dyarchy never commenced; it supplied much of the institutional architecture later adapted in 1950, yet its restricted franchise, safeguards and executive supremacy remained colonial.

13

STAGE 13 INDIAN INDEPENDENCE ACT 1947 — THE SOVEREIGNTY BRIDGE

ATTLEE ANNOUNCEMENT — 20 FEB 1947 · MOUNTBATTEN PLAN — 3 JUN 1947 · ROYAL ASSENT — 18 JUL 1947 · APPOINTED DAY — 15 AUG 1947 · TWO DOMINIONS · PARAMOUNTCY LAPSED · VICEROY ABOLISHED · SECRETARY OF STATE ABOLISHED · “EMPEROR OF INDIA” TITLE DROPPED · 1935 ACT ADAPTED AS INTERIM LAW

20 Feb 1947 Attlee announces the transfer deadline
3 Jun 1947 Mountbatten Plan
18 Jul 1947 Indian Independence Act receives royal assent
15 Aug 1947 Appointed day: two Dominions come into being
26 Nov 1949 Constitution adopted — endpoint belongs to Polity 02
26 Jan 1950 Constitution commences; India becomes a Republic

WHAT ENDED

- **British rule and British sovereignty** over India.
- The office of **Viceroy**.
- The office of **Secretary of State for India**.
- **The British Parliament's power to legislate** for a Dominion after the appointed day.
- The title **"Emperor of India"**.

WHAT WAS CREATED

- Two independent **Dominions, India and Pakistan**, with the right to secede from the Commonwealth.
- A **Governor-General for each Dominion**, and — with the provincial Governors — a **constitutional, nominal head acting on ministers' advice**.
- **Constituent Assemblies as sovereign legislative bodies**, able to frame any constitution and to repeal British Acts, and to legislate until the new constitutions.
- Interim governance under the **adapted Government of India Act 1935**.

WHAT LAPSED — AND THE PROBLEM IT CREATED

- **British paramountcy over the princely states lapsed**, along with treaty relations.
- States were left **free to join India or Pakistan or remain independent**.
- Paramountcy did **not** transfer automatically to India: **integration became an Indian political task, not an automatic legal succession**.

LIMIT → The Constituent Assembly did **not** first come into existence under this Act: it was formed earlier under the **Cabinet Mission framework**, and the 1947 Act made it **sovereign**. Legal sovereignty therefore arrived **before** the Republic. Detailed Assembly composition, committees and debates belong to **Polity 02** — do not import them here.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The Independence Act 1947 ended British sovereignty and paramountcy and made the Constituent Assemblies sovereign legislatures, but left integration and constitution-making to Indian agency.

14

STAGE 14 EXAM SYNTHESIS — SPINE, FOUR-QUESTION MATRIX, TRAP LEDGER AND PYQ ROUTES

THE SPINE IS THE ANSWER STRUCTURE · PROVIDED ≠ OPERATED · ASSOCIATION ≠ REPRESENTATION ≠ RESPONSIBILITY · STRUCTURAL CONTINUITY + NORMATIVE RUPTURE · 4 VERIFIED PRELIMS PYQS · NO DIRECT MAINS PYQ IN THE AUDITED LOCAL CORPUS

COMPANY TRADE 1600 charter → **TERRITORIAL-REVENUE POWER** 1757–1765 → **PARLIAMENTARY REGULATION** 1773–1781 → **DUAL CONTROL** 1784–1858 → **CROWN RULE** 1858

ASSOCIATION 1861–1892 → **REPRESENTATION** 1909 → **PROVINCIAL RESPONSIBILITY** 1919 → **FEDERAL / AUTONOMY ARCHITECTURE** 1935 → **SOVEREIGNTY** 1947 → 1950

THE FOUR-QUESTION COMPARISON MATRIX — 1773 · 1784 · 1858 · 1919 · 1935 · 1947

ACT	WHO CONTROLLED THE EXECUTIVE	WHO MADE LAW	WHO WAS REPRESENTED	CEILING OF THE STATUTE
1773	Governor-General of Bengal in a four-member Council; Court of Directors merely reports.	Governor-General-in-Council for Bengal; presidency Regulations.	**Nobody Indian.**	Centralisation and a royal court, with no rule for resolving executive or jurisdictional conflict.
1784	British Government through the **Board of Control**; Company machinery executes.	Unchanged in form; policy direction moves to London.	**Nobody Indian.**	Dual control: supreme political supervision without transfer of the territories.
1858	**Secretary of State for India** in the British Cabinet; **Viceroy** in India.	Governor-General-in-Council under Crown authority.	**Nobody Indian** — the accountability chain runs to the British electorate.	Imperial accountability centralised; Indian popular responsibility absent.
1919	Governor with Executive Council for **reserved** subjects; ministers for **transferred** subjects.	Bicameral central legislature; provincial legislatures with elected members.	A **restricted, communally segmented** electorate.	Provincial responsibility without finance, police or freedom from override.
1935	Provincial ministries under **gubernatorial safeguards**; proposed central dyarchy never operated.	Federal, Provincial and Concurrent Lists; residuary with the Governor-General.	Roughly **one-tenth**, qualification-based, with widened separate representation.	A federal and autonomy template that never became sovereign.
1947	**Governor-General as constitutional head** acting on ministers' advice.	**Constituent Assemblies as sovereign legislatures**; 1935 Act adapted as interim law.	Representation now determined by **Indian constituent power**.	Sovereignty transferred; integration and constitution-making left to Indian agency.

TRAP LEDGER — DO NOT WRITE THESE

- Regulating Act created the Governor-General of **India** → it created the Governor-General of **Bengal**; India comes with **1833**.
- 1853 abolished the Company → the Company was abolished by the **1858 Act**.
- Morley–Minto 1909 introduced dyarchy → dyarchy is **1919**; 1909 is the **communal electorate**.
- 1919 introduced provincial autonomy → that is **1935**; 1919 is **dyarchy**.
- Residuary powers under 1935 went to the provinces → they went to the **Governor-General / Viceroy**.
- The 1935 federation actually functioned → it was **never formed**; the princely states stayed out.
- First Indian on the Viceroy's council under 1919 → **S. P. Sinha, under 1909**.
- More dates mean more marks → dates earn marks **only when tied to institutional meaning**.

FIRSTS — PRELIMS GOLD

FIRST	ACT
Governor-General of Bengal (Warren Hastings)	Regulating Act 1773
Supreme Court at Calcutta	Regulating Act 1773
Board of Control / double government	Pitt's India Act 1784
Governor-General of India (William Bentinck)	Charter Act 1833
Separation of legislative and executive; open competition	Charter Act 1853
Viceroy (Lord Canning); Secretary of State	GoI Act 1858
Portfolio system recognised; Indians in law-making	Councils Act 1861
Separate electorate for Muslims (Minto)	Councils Act 1909
First Indian in Viceroy's Executive Council (S. P. Sinha)	Councils Act 1909
Dyarchy in provinces; bicameralism; direct election	GoI Act 1919
Provincial autonomy; Federal Court; PSC scheme	GoI Act 1935

VERIFIED PYQ ROUTES

- **2018 Prelims GS-I Q38** — residuary powers under the 1935 federation → **(b) Governor-General**. Cross-owned by Modern History; key inferred.
- **2019 Prelims GS-I Q4** — Charter Act 1813 statements → **(a) 1 and 2 only**. Cross-owned; key inferred.
- **2023 Prelims GS-I Q50** — GG of Bengal redesignated GG of India → **(d) Charter Act 1833**. Cross-owned; key inferred.
- **2024 Prelims GS-I Q62** — 1935 federation and defence/foreign affairs → **(a) 1 only**. **Direct Polity 01 owner; official paper and key verified locally.**

ANSWER ARCHITECTURE BY MARKS

- **10 marks:** three to four named statutes.
- **15 marks:** six to seven, with one comparison.
- **20 marks:** eight to ten, with comparison and explicit qualification.
- Evidence density must rise with marks **without becoming a catalogue**.
- Periodise by **constitutional function**, never by monarch or viceroy.

PARAGRAPH FORMULA — USE IT EVERY TIME

- **Claim → named provision or evidence → significance for power, accountability or representation → limitation.**
- For continuity questions: **structural continuity plus normative rupture**, then two retained examples, two rejected devices, one qualification.
- Retained: three-list distribution, Governors, courts, services, emergency and strong centre — all **re-founded on popular sovereignty**.
- Rejected: **separate electorates, restricted franchise, imperial supremacy**.
- End with a **calibrated verdict**, never 'therefore British rule was good or bad'.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — CONTINUITY (WRITE/ADAPT): The Constitution retained and transformed colonial machinery — lists, Governors, courts and services — while rejecting communal electorates, restricted franchise and imperial supremacy; constitutional continuity lies in structures, not in democratic legitimacy.

REQUIRED FINAL VERDICT → The best periodisation is **centralisation, association, limited responsibility and sovereign constitution-making**; chronology earns marks only when converted into institutional argument. Colonial constitutional reform was neither a linear gift nor a single nationalist victory: British control incentives and Indian political pressure interacted, while authority remained deliberately short of popular sovereignty. **CORE FLOW COMPLETE HERE** — everything below is optional enrichment and cannot repair or replace a missing primary stage.

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL DEPTH · LIGHTER VISUAL WEIGHT · THE CORE ABOVE REMAINS SUFFICIENT · NAMED OFFICERS AND MINOR PERSONS · SOURCE DISPUTES FLAGGED, NOT RESOLVED · SUPPLEMENTARY FACTS — LOW YIELD · READ LAST, REVISE FIRST FROM THE CORE

MINOR OFFICERS AND NAMED PERSONS

- **Warren Hastings** — first Governor-General of Bengal; **Cornwallis** — 1786 override and Commander-in-Chief; **Bentinck** — first Governor-General of India.
- **Macaulay** — first Law Member (1833) and chair of the 1854 civil-service committee.
- **Canning** — portfolio system from 1859, first Viceroy in 1858, and the nominator of the 1862 non-officials.
- **Raja of Benaras, Maharaja of Patiala, Sir Dinkar Rao** — the 1862 nominated non-officials.
- **Satyendra Prasad Sinha**, **Lord Minto**, **Ramsay MacDonald**, **Gandhi** and **B. R. Ambedkar** at Poona.

SOURCE AND EVIDENCE DISPUTES

- Official answer keys for the **2018, 2019 and 2023** Prelims items are **unavailable locally**; those answers are prominently **inferred**, not officially verified. Only **2024 Q62** has both official paper and official key verified locally.
- **RBI attribution** to the 1935 Act is a standard shorthand; the constituting statute is the **Reserve Bank of India Act 1934**.
- The **~10% franchise** figure is an approximation and must not be converted into a precise electorate count.
- UPSC stems sometimes use **'established'** loosely for the 1935 federation; state the **legal-operational distinction** rather than contradicting the stem.
- Cross-owned mechanism detail on 1773–1784 (Council deadlock, Nand Kumar/Patna/Cossijurah, Secret Committee) comes from the **Modern Indian History Topic 06** owner, not from the Polity Basic owner.

SUPPLEMENTARY FACTS

- New legislative councils: **Bengal 1862, North-Western Provinces 1886, Punjab 1897**.
- **Board of Control staff paid from Indian revenues** under the Charter Act 1793.
- **Local governments empowered to impose taxes** under the Charter Act 1813.
- **High Commissioner for India** in London under the 1919 Act; **Burma separated** in 1937; **Congress ministries resigned in 1939**.
- Local self-government history also includes **executive resolutions and provincial laws** beyond the central Acts; constitutional devolution arrives only with **Parts IX and IX-A**.

STATUS → **APPROVAL: FALSE.** This is generation g9, a non-canonical alternative pending user review. No prior artefact — including the rejected generation g8, the canonical learner-v2 Markdown, the notes and workbook PDFs, or the tracker — has been modified.